



Mount Fuji

An iconic, beautifully symmetrical volcano that can be seen from Tokyo on a clear day

Rising to a height of 12,388 ft (3,776 m), and located 55 miles (90 km) southwest of Tokyo, Mount Fuji is the highest mountain in Japan. Mostly formed 11,000–8,000 years ago, its attractive cone is one of the country's most famous symbols, often celebrated in art and literature, as well as visited by sightseers and climbers. Although it is classified as an active volcano, Fuji's last eruption—which covered a huge area to its east in ash—was in December 1707. Since then, there have been no further signs of volcanic activity.

▷ BLOSSOM SEASON

The spring flowering of cherry trees is admired so much in the Mount Fuji area that there is an official cherry blossom viewing season, called *Hanami*.

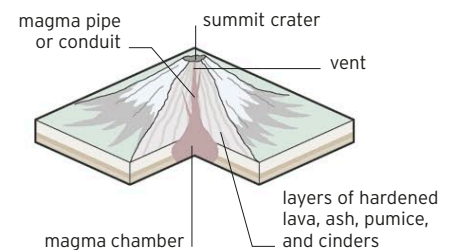


△ CELEBRATED CONE

Fuji's cone has a base around 12 miles (20 km) wide and is almost perfectly symmetrical. It is snow-capped from October to June.

INSIDE MOUNT FUJI

Fuji is a stratovolcano—a steep-sided volcano composed of layers of solidified lava alternating with ash and other ejected material. The successive layers have built the volcano into a tall cone.



Kliuchevskoi

The highest active volcano outside the Americas, situated on Russia's Kamchatka Peninsula and regarded as sacred by the native population



▽ LAVA RIVER

In this photo taken in 2015, a lava flow runs down Kliuchevskoi while plumes of steam, ash, and other volcanic gases escape into the atmosphere.

Also known as Klyuchevskaya Sopka, Kliuchevskoi is one of the most active, as well as the highest of a dense chain of more than 160 volcanoes that run down the Kamchatka Peninsula. The volcanoes are the result of the Pacific and North American plates subducting (sliding under) the small Okhotsk Plate, on which Kamchatka sits. This process provoked the formation of magma at depth, which moved upward to create the volcanoes.

Dangerous beauty

Originally formed around 6,000 years ago, Kliuchevskoi has been erupting almost continually since at least the late 17th century, including significant eruptions in 2007, 2010, 2012, 2013, and 2015. Due to its frequent eruptions, the peak has not been climbed often. A beautiful, symmetrical, snow-capped volcano, Kliuchevskoi is regarded by some of Kamchatka's native people as the place where the world was created.

